

SkyCue – Financial Model & Cash-Flow Break-Even

Planning model. All USD. Every figure labeled `[fact]`, `[estimate]`, or `[assumption]`. Sources: `skycrow/01-hardware-bom.md`, `02-campaign.md`, `03-partner-model.md`, `04-webapp-streaming.md`, `05-roadmap.md`; 2026 market data (The Knot / Zola / Rateven / wedding.report: 2.01M US weddings/yr, avg videographer \$2,300–3,500, premium cinematic \$5,000–10,000+ [fact]).

1. Inputs & assumptions

Input	Value	Label
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Campaign goal / duration	\$50K, 34 days	[fact]
Campaign raise (base)	\$400K gross	[fact-range: your base case]
Platform + payment fees	~8% of raise	[fact]
Crowdfunding hardware margin	25–35% (fees + shipping compress)	[estimate]
Kit hardware margin (post-campaign, COTS)	35%, rising to ~42–48% with volume + custom airframe	[estimate]
Lease/rental margin	45% (depreciation + insurance + refurb)	[estimate]
Software subs margin	85%	[estimate]
Franchise margin	70%	[estimate]
Add-on services margin	70%	[estimate]
Venue program margin	60%	[assumption]
Pre-campaign runway needed (proto + pilot + list-building)	\$60–80K	[estimate]
Opex excludes founder draw	–	[assumption]

Revenue streams: **S1** hardware kits & modules · **S2** software subs (Certified Partner \$49–99/mo, Venue Planner \$29–59/event, Edit \$49/event, stream \$19/event) · **S3** lease/rental (\$350–1,200/event rent; \$200–1,400/mo lease) · **S4** franchise (\$25K + 8–12% rev share) · **S5** add-ons (Sight-Line, Fund-a-Guest fees) · **S6** venue program (API licensing / venue-owned hardware rev share; from Y3) [all priced in `02`/`03`/`04`].

2. Base case – revenue streams by year

\$K	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5
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S1 Hardware	400 (campaign)	340	520	700	900
S2 Software subs	–	80	220	450	800
S3 Lease/rental	–	220	474	800	1,200
S4 Franchise	–	50	200	350	500
S5 Add-ons	20 (pilot)	70	200	400	700
S6 Venue program	–	–	180	500	1,100
Total	420	760	1,800	3,200	5,200

Cumulative 5-yr revenue (base): **~\$11.4M** [estimate]

Base case – quarterly revenue

\$K	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
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Y1	0	20	300	100
Y2	140	170	210	240
Y3	360	420	490	530
Y4	700	780	840	880
Y5	1,150	1,250	1,350	1,450

3. Base case – quarterly cash flow & break-even

Net operating cash = revenue – COGS – opex – inventory build – platform fees. Excludes founder draw, taxes, and the \$60–80K pre-campaign runway (funded before Q1 Y1).

\$K	Net cash	Cumulative
Y1 Q1 (prototype)	-25	-25
Y1 Q2 (pilot)	0	-25
Y1 Q3 (campaign close)	+46	+21
Y1 Q4 (fulfillment wave 1)	-48	-27
Y2 Q1 (fulfillment trough)	** -26 **	** -53 **
Y2 Q2	+5	-48
Y2 Q3	+35	-13
Y2 Q4	+70	** +57 **
Y3 Q1	+105	+162
Y3 Q2	+142	+304
Y3 Q3	+170	+474
Y3 Q4	+196	+670
Y4 Q1	+274	+944
Y4 Q2	+315	+1,259
Y4 Q3	+349	+1,608
Y4 Q4	+367	+1,975
Y5 Q1	+502	+2,477
Y5 Q2	+555	+3,032
Y5 Q3	+608	+3,640
Y5 Q4	+656	+4,296

****Break-even (base):**** operating cash flow turns durable positive in ****Y2 Q2****; cumulative cash turns positive ****Y2 Q4****. Cash trough $\approx$ ****-\$55K at Y2 Q1**** (the fulfillment COGS wave).

4. Gross margin, opex & EBITDA by year (base)

\$K	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5
Revenue	420	760	1,800	3,200	5,200
Gross profit	105	370	970	1,812	3,035
Opex (support, webapp, insurance, marketing, hires from Y3)	80	150	280	450	650
EBITDA	**+25**	**+220**	**+690**	**+1,362**	**+2,385**

Cumulative EBITDA 5-yr (base): ****~\$4.7M****. The recurring mix (software/franchise/venue) is what pushes margin from 25% $\rightarrow$ 58% GP over the model [estimate].

****Founder-draw sensitivity:**** opex excludes a founder salary. A \$70K/yr draw cuts EBITDA to $\backslash$ -45 / +150 / +620 / +1,292 / +2,315` and pushes cumulative-cash-positive back ~2 quarters (Y3 Q1). Still break-even-positive in base; margin is thin enough that ****a draw in Y1 is what consumes the pre-campaign \$60–80K runway****, so draw from Y2 on [assumption].

5. Conservative scenario (annual)

Story: campaign hits 5 $\times$ goal, shipping slips 6–12 mo, half the hoped-for partners, venue program stalls.

\$K	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5
Revenue	260	330	600	1,000	1,600

Gross profit	57	148	282	490	800
Opex	75	130	220	330	450
EBITDA	-18	+18	+62	+160	+350
End-of-year cumulative cash	-10	+55	+240	+480	+830

Break-even: **Y2 Q4** (cumulative cash); trough $\approx$ -\$45K at Y2 Q1. Cumulative 5-yr revenue: **~\$3.8M**; cash **~\$1.6M** [estimate].

6. Optimistic scenario (annual)

Story: viral short-form + B2B leads $\rightarrow$ \$800K-1M raise, on-time fulfillment, franchise sells out,
venue + schools/sports verticals land.

\$K	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5
Revenue	800	1,300	3,500	6,500	11,000
Gross profit	220	560	1,960	3,900	6,800
Opex	100	220	450	750	1,100
EBITDA	+120	+340	+1,510	+3,150	+5,700
End-of-year cumulative cash	+150	+650	+1,900	+3,800	+6,800

Break-even: cumulative cash never negative after the campaign. Cumulative 5-yr revenue: **~\$23M**; cash **~\$6.8M** [estimate].

7. Scenario comparison

	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
Campaign raise	\$250K	\$400K	\$800K
5-yr revenue	~\$3.8M	~\$11.4M	~\$23M
5-yr cumulative cash	~\$1.6M	~\$4.3M	~\$6.8M
Cash trough	-\$45K (Y2 Q1)	-\$55K (Y2 Q1)	never after campaign
Durable break-even	Y2 Q4	Y2 Q2	Y4 of Y1 (campaign)
Partners by end Y5	~150	~350	~800

8. Sensitivities – what moves the model most

1. **Partner count** (highest lever). Every 100 partners $\approx$ \$0.8–1.2M/yr of blended revenue by Y4–Y5. Own 18-mo target is 100 active partners; base assumes ~60 by end Y2 [assumption].
2. **Fulfillment delay**. A 6–12 mo slip shifts the whole curve right: Y2 becomes the Conservative Y1. Protect with the COTS/no-tooling first batch and conservative 6–8 mo ship promise [fact: designed in].
3. **Hardware margin**. Volume buys (–10–25%) + custom carbon airframe (–10% cost) lift kit margin from ~35% to ~42–48% by Y4 [estimate]. Second-order but large at scale.
4. **Founder draw**. A salary from Y1 doubles the pre-campaign funding need; defer to Y2.
5. **Indoor gate fails**. Fallback = outdoor-first = commodity positioning; drop Y3+ venue and premium-package assumptions by ~50%, and expect price compression (DJI incumbency).
6. **Recurring layer timing**. Software/franchise/venue only turn material Y3+. If the webapp slips, base-case Y3–Y5 revenue falls ~20–30%.

9. Pre-campaign funding & validation gates

- ****Runway needed before launch:**** ~\$60–80K (Phase 0–2 prototypes, pilot events, 2,500–5,000 email list build). This is the real seed ask [estimate].
- ****Gate 1 – indoor positioning:**** hover/hold <0.10 m + pod→drone→angle in <15 s. Kill-or-go before campaign [fact: roadmap Phase 1].
- ****Gate 2 – pilot evidence:**** ≥15 real events, 0 serious incidents, NPS + case studies from 3–5 certified partners. This is what justifies the premium tier in the campaign [fact: roadmap Phase 2].
- ****Gate 3 – campaign day 1:**** 25–30% of goal pre-committed from the email list, else pull the launch [fact: campaign doc].

10. Bottom line

- Demand math and structure are sound; the base case is a ****profitable ~\$5M/yr company**** and ~\$11.4M cumulative revenue over 5 years [estimate].
- Cash (not revenue) is the constraint: pre-campaign \$60–80K + the Y2 Q1 fulfillment trough (~\$55K) are the two moments the business can die on cash.
- Re-run this model quarterly from actuals once the campaign lands; every year the partner count is the number to watch.